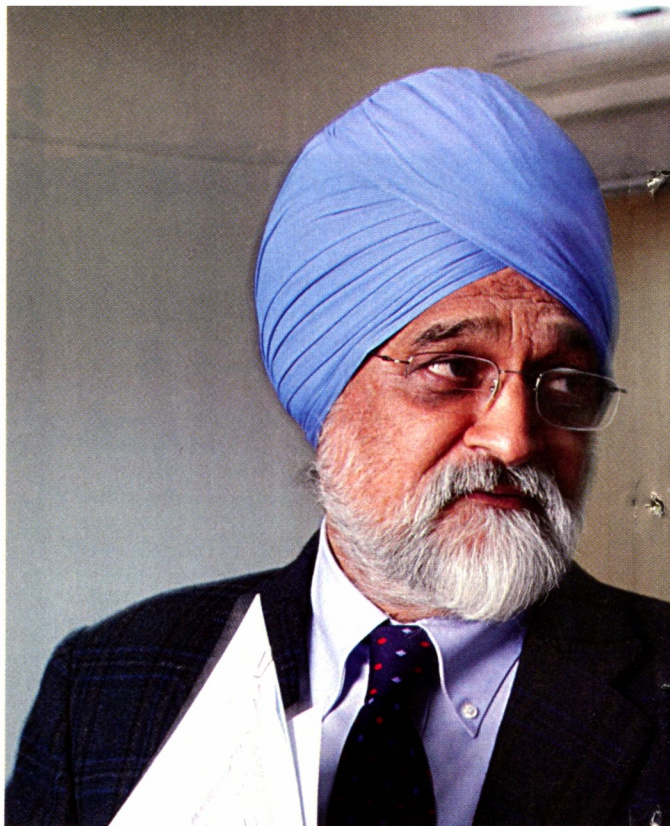


Top 10 Advisers

It is their perseverance and tenacity combined with rare talent that makes them indispensable to the Government

In a city where everyone thinks he is a power unto himself, they are the ones who wield invisible influence. Not because they are elected to public office but because they are selected by those who were. A varied mix of economists, scientists, technocrats, legal eagles and bureaucrats, most of them steer clear of the 24x7 media gaze, though some do so only with difficulty. Be it the economist who the prime minister has given a free hand to turn the Yojana Bhavan into a catalyst of real change, the legal eagle on whom the government falls back each time it finds itself in a quandary, the bureaucrat selected by the Union home minister to handle the diverse threats from Maoists, jihadis and other enemies within and without, or the diplomat plucked out of retirement to handle the Government's initiatives in the neighbourhood, all of them are blessed in abundance with qualities of perseverance, tenacity and doggedness. They also have in common a proven track record of rising to meet any challenge. That's why, despite their low profiles, they exercise immense clout. It's visible in every aspect of national life, from the Union Budget to education reforms, from a revolutionary unique identification card to the National Knowledge Network. They are the policy-makers, the key connectors between we, the people, and they, the politicians.

by Ashok K. Damodaran



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C.R. RANGARAJAN

78, Chairperson, PM's Economic Advisory Council

Straight Talker

Because as one of the prime minister's closest economic advisers, he can tell him exactly what he thinks.

Because when he tells the Government to continue with the stimulus or partially roll back sops, he is heard.

Because whether it was the reform of the exchange rate regime in 1992 or fixing policy chinks in energy pricing, Manmohan Singh has always depended on him for counsel.

Because he can call 7 Race Course Road, and get an appointment with the prime minister fast-tracked.

Power read *Lords of Finance: The Bankers who Broke the World* by Liaquat Ahamed.



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